

letters to friends, learn to speed read. Write computer programs, learn to play the sax, join a hospital board. Go to the club for lunch, see friends, go to theater, concerts, movies, and ballets. Go to the beach, travel. Spend more time with Vicki.

It's less exciting than, say, the kind of list a kinky sex manual might recommend for planning an orgy. And even with a good list, you'll still have a couple of days as dull as a Phi Beta Kappa newsletter. But during my first year of retirement I went over the list every few weeks. "Join a hospital board" led me to inquire and decide I couldn't do much as a board member. The hospital near me is so mismanaged that Alfred Sloan himself couldn't help. I need that kind of challenge like I need my old accounting books. "Learn to play the sax" led me to sax lessons. I now play with friends in a nine-piece modern jazz band and, on occasion, with a bar piano player.

Your list should have a second section with interests rather than things to do. Mine has academic interests like history, anthropology, geography, philosophy, and physics. I also list industries that fascinate me: airlines, farming, computers, television, and pharmaceuticals. Farming, for example, led Vicki and me to arrange a six-day visit to a cattle ranch in Argentina. Later, we accompanied a wine-connoisseur friend on a two-week trip through the Argentine wine country. We liked Argentina so much we decided to retire there. (In chapter 5 I talk about setting up in a foreign country.)

If you have kids, you need a list of things *they'd* like to do, given that Mom and Dad will have more time. Getting your kids' ideas on paper will help you choose activities that are fun for them *and* you.

Traveling is a big part of most retirements. You can wander through Morocco, Algeria, Tunisia, or Egypt; study tribal history in Bali, Thailand, Sri Lanka, Malaysia, or Singapore; compare agricultural methods in Greece, Turkey, Bulgaria, and Russia; learn about Eastern religions in India, China, and